TOOL

Phrase bank

Exam-ready phrases for every text type. Build them into your own sentences.

AHS: essay, article, report, blog, e-mail. BHS: article, report, blog, e-mail, leaflet.

ESSAY (AHS ONLY)

Giving your opinion (without overusing "I")

- It is widely believed that...
- One can argue that...
- Many people are convinced that...
- For many people,...
- It is often argued that...

When you do use "I"

- In my opinion/view,...
- I am inclined to believe that...
- I (firmly) believe that...
- I am (not) convinced that...

Adding arguments

- Furthermore,...
- Moreover,...
- In addition to this,...
- What is more,...
- Not only... but also...

Introducing the other side

- One should, nevertheless, consider...
- The other side of the coin is that...
- On the other hand,...
- Admittedly,...

Conclusions

- Taking these points into consideration,...
- All of this points to the conclusion that...
- On balance, we can safely say that...
- The arguments presented prove that...

ARTICLE

Openings

- Have you ever...?
- Do you remember the first time that...?
- Are you one of those people who...?
- There is nothing worse than...

Engaging throughout

- Can you imagine...?
- If you ask me,...
- You may not agree with me, but...
- I will never forget the time when...
- To be honest, it scares me when I think that...

Conclusions

- So next time you...
- The question is not whether... but when.
- Perhaps it's time we all...
- Food for thought, isn't it?

REPORT

Introduction

- As requested, I have prepared a report on...
- The aim of this report is to...
- This report examines/compares...
- The data was collected through...

Presenting data

- Twenty per cent of the people asked...
- The majority of respondents...
- One in five stated that...
- It is generally felt that...
- A large proportion of those interviewed...

Conclusion / Recommendations

- On the basis of these findings,...
- I would therefore recommend/suggest that...
- It would seem that... is the best option.
- In view of this, one can recommend...
- It would also be advisable to...

BLOG

Blog post openers

- It took me ages to figure this out, but...
- So, here's what I've been thinking about...
- You won't believe what happened to me...
- OK so hear me out –

Blog comment openers

- Hi [name], I've just seen your blog on...
- I stumbled across your post and...
- This really resonated with me because...

Engaging the reader

- What do you think?
- I'd love to hear your thoughts on this.
- Let me know in the comments!
- Has anyone else experienced this?
- Am I the only one who...?

E-MAIL

Complaint openers

- I am writing to express my dissatisfaction with...
- I am writing to complain about...
- I would like to draw your attention to...
- I was appalled to find...

Application openers

- I am writing to apply for the position of... as advertised in...
- I am writing with reference to your advertisement...
- I believe I am suitable for the position as I...

Letter to the editor openers

- I am writing in response to the article on..., which appeared in... on [date].
- I have just read your article on... and I feel I must respond.
- You raised some issues which I feel strongly about.

Closings (all sub-types)

- I look forward to hearing from you at your earliest convenience.
- I look forward to receiving the information requested.
- I am available for an interview at your convenience.
- Thank you for your cooperation in correcting this matter.

LEAFLET (BHS ONLY)

Attention-grabbing openers

- Looking for something to do this summer?
- Ever wondered what goes on behind our doors?
- New to the area? Here is where to start.
- Something new is coming to your town – and everyone is welcome.
- Good news for anyone who loves...

Describing & persuading

- Whether you are a complete beginner or already experienced,...
- There really is something for everyone.
- It is easier – and cheaper – than you might think.
- Best of all, it is completely free.
- No experience needed – just come as you are.

Direct address & calls to action

- Come along and see for yourself.
- Sign up today – places are limited.
- Bring a friend and make a day of it.
- Find out more on our website.
- Do not miss out.

Practical information & closings

- When: Saturday, 14 June, from 10 a.m.
- Where: the main hall, Hauptstraße 1.
- Entry is free. / Tickets: €5.
- For more information, visit www....
- Questions? Call us on... or drop by any weekday.

E-MAIL SUB-TYPES

Letter / E-mail of Complaint

Opening

- I am writing to express my dissatisfaction with...
- I am writing to complain about...
- I would like to draw your attention to a serious problem regarding...
- I feel I must bring to your attention...

Describing the problem

- ...was not what we had been led to expect
- It was not up to the standard advertised.
- To make matters worse,...
- We were extremely disappointed to find that...
- The situation was further complicated by the fact that...

Making demands

- I would like you to refund my money.
- I expect a full explanation for this situation.
- Unless I receive a satisfactory reply within 14 days, I will be forced to...
- I would be grateful if you could rectify this matter immediately.
- I am requesting a partial refund of...

Letter / E-mail of Application

Opening

- I am writing to apply for the position of... as advertised in...
- I am writing with reference to your advertisement for...
- Having seen your advertisement in..., I would like to apply for...

Qualifications & experience

- I am currently a [age]-year-old student at...
- My qualifications include...
- For the past [time], I have...
- I gained valuable experience while...
- As you can see from my attached CV,...

Closing

- I look forward to hearing from you at your earliest convenience.
- I trust this matter will be dealt with promptly.
- Thank you for your cooperation in correcting this matter.

Suitability

- I believe I am suitable for this position as I...
- I consider myself to be enthusiastic, hard-working, and reliable.
- My experience in... has prepared me well for...
- I have developed strong skills in... through my work at...

Closing

- I am available for an interview at your convenience.
- I look forward to discussing my application further.
- Please do not hesitate to contact me if you require any further information.
- I would welcome the opportunity to contribute to your organisation.

Letter to the Editor

Opening – reference the article

- I am writing in response to the article entitled "...", which appeared in... on [date].
- I have just read your article on... and feel I must respond.
- I am writing with reference to the article published in last month's issue of...
- Your recent article on... raises issues which I feel strongly about.

Agreeing

- I completely agree with the view expressed in your article that...
- I was pleased to read your article on..., as it reflects my own experience.
- It is certainly true that...
- The author makes an excellent point when they argue that...

Disagreeing

- I am afraid I must respectfully disagree with the position expressed.
- While I understand the argument, I cannot agree that...
- The author fails to consider...
- It is simply not true that...
- While I completely agree that..., I cannot accept...

Conclusion / Call to action

- I sincerely hope that... will reconsider this position.
- May I draw your readers' attention to...
- What we must do is ensure that...
- I urge your readers to...
- I hope this letter will contribute to a wider debate on this issue.

E-mail of Enquiry / Requesting Information

Opening

- I am writing to enquire about...
- I would like to request further information about...
- I am writing on behalf of... to enquire whether...
- Having seen your advertisement for..., I am writing to find out more details about...

Asking questions (indirect form)

- I would like to know whether...
- Could you please tell me...?
- I would be grateful if you could inform me of...
- I would appreciate it if you could clarify...
- I was wondering whether it might be possible to...

Closing

- I look forward to receiving the information requested.
- I would appreciate a prompt reply, as I need to make arrangements by...
- Please do not hesitate to contact me if you require any further information.
- I look forward to hearing from you.

LINKING WORDS: FROM BASIC TO B2

Function	Basic	B2 alternatives
Adding	and, also	Furthermore · Moreover · In addition · What is more · Not only… but also
Contrasting	but	However · Nevertheless · On the other hand · Nonetheless · Although · Despite
Cause	because	Since · As · Due to the fact that · Owing to
Result	so	Therefore · Consequently · As a result · Thus · Hence
Example	like	For instance · For example · Take for example · A case in point is
Concession	but	Admittedly · Although · Even though · While · Despite the fact that
Conclusion	to finish	To sum up · Taking everything into account · All things considered · On balance